



DECISION

Complaint No. : POS/2614/2025/F-40/Adv-I

Name and address of the complainant : Mr. Bilal Hassan, R/o. House No. L-122, Near Masjid Haji Abdullah, Mohalla Islam Ganj, Khewra Pind dadan Khan, District Jhelum, Punjab.

Name of the Agency Complained against : Municipal Commissioner, Keamari / UC-10 Jackson

Name & Designation of Investigating Officer : Mr. Shahid Ahmed Hashmi, Advisor Legal

Vetted by :

Subject : COMPLAINT REGARDING ALLEGED ISSUANCE OF FAKE DEATH CERTIFICATE OF THE COMPLAINANT BY OFFICIALS OF UC-10 JACKSON ON RECEIPT OF BRIBE FROM HIS EX-WIFE.

THE COMPLAINT.

Mr. Bilal Hassan filed the instant complaint dated 25.04.2025 against Union Committee No. 11, Jackson, alleging issuance of a fake death certificate in his name. It has been averred that the said death certificate was fraudulently issued on the behest of his former wife, with whom his strained matrimonial relationship ended within two years in divorce in the year 2010. The complainant asserted that he is alive, residing at House No. L-122, Near Masjid Haji Abdullah, Mohalla Islam Ganj, Khewra Pind, Dadan Khan, District Jhelum, Punjab. In his memo of complaint, the complainant asserted that the impugned death certificate has caused him serious legal and social prejudice, exposing him to potential loss of civil rights, property complications, and reputational harm.

PROCEEDINGS:

2. The complainant was contacted on his given number, whereupon he expressed his inability to travel to Karachi for lodging FIR and pursuing the matter. He requested for cancellation of such certificate and also sought facilitation for initiating action against the persons responsible for issuance of the fake death certificate. He was accordingly advised to complete the codal formalities required for investigation of the matter.

3. Upon completion of the requisite formalities, the memo of complaint was initially forwarded to the Deputy Commissioner, Jhelum, Punjab, with a request to verify the aliveness of the complainant in light of the particulars mentioned in the impugned death certificate. In response, the Deputy Commissioner, vide letter dated 04.08.2025, informed this office that the Assistant Commissioner, Pind Dadan Khan, had sought a report from Chief Officer, Municipal Commissioner, Khewra, who, through his report dated 27.10.2025, categorically confirmed that the complainant was alive. The report was accompanied by the personal statement of the complainant.

4. Subsequently, a report was called from the respondent Union Committee vide notice dated 04.08.2025, directing the Secretary to appear in person on 19.08.2025 along with the relevant record.

5. On the scheduled date of hearing, the Secretary appeared and submitted a report revealing that the impugned death certificate had been issued by Mr. Farooq Channa, an employee of the Council, on the basis of documents submitted with the request, which were later found to be bogus during internal inquiry.

6. Thereafter, a fresh compliance report dated 30.12.2025 was submitted by the Agency, informing that the death certificate had been cancelled after determining that all supporting documents were unverified. The Secretary tendered an apology for the inconvenience caused to the complainant.

FINDINGS:

7. From the material on record, it stands established that:
- i. The fake death certificate was originally issued by the respondent Union Committee through its official machinery.
 - ii. Verification of the complainant's live status by the Deputy Commissioner, Jhelum conclusively proved that the complainant was alive.
 - iii. The impugned certificate was cancelled vide refe.e No. UC-10/1175/2025 dated 30.12.2025. However, the matter does not only pertain to a minor procedural lapse.
 - iv. The act of declaring a living person dead, without lawful verification, reflects either gross criminal negligence or a deliberate attempt to facilitate fraud, potentially aimed at usurping the complainant's property or civil rights.
 - v. Mere expression of regret by the respondent agency cannot absolve it of responsibility. The failure to safeguard the sanctity and authenticity of vital public records amounts to serious maladministration and erosion of public trust.

DECISION:

8. Given the foregoing reasons, and in exercise of power conferred in me under section 10 of the Office of Ombudsman for the province of Sindh Act, 1991 (Amendment up to date), I hereby direct to Secretary Local Government GOS to:
- i. Fix responsibility upon the officials involved in issuance of the impugned certificate and proceed against them in accordance with law.
 - ii. Refer the matter to the ACE for determination of criminal liability, if any.
 - iii. Issue direction to all local councils to ensure strict compliance with statutory procedures for issuance of vital records / certificate to prevent recurrence of such incidents. A detailed compliance report shall be submitted to this office within 45 days.

Given under my hand and seal of office



Sd /-
(Muhammad Sohail Rajput)
Sitara-e-Imtiaz, PAS
Ombudsman Sindh
 Karachi, dated January, 2026

27.11